

Dutch Prize Papers Version-1

Data-Envelope Version-1

DataEnvelope

status

under construction

Level 1: Basic Information

1.1. Title of Data-Envelope

Dutch Prize Papers Version-1 Data-Envelope Version-1

1.2. Contact Details

Name

Marijcke Schillings

ORCID ID

<https://orcid.org/0000-0001-7534-2652>

roleInProject

Project Administration

Email

prizepapers@huygens.knaw.nl

1.3. Data Envelope Dates

Data-Envelope Creation Date

2024-10-07

1.4 Author of Data-Envelope

Name

Mari Wigham

orcidID

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email

data@huygens.knaw.nl

Level 2: Basic Metadata

2.1 Snapshot

Dataset Title

Dutch Prize Papers

Version

1

Description

The Dutch Prize Papers database makes digitally available a selection of mainly Dutch documents from the Prize Papers. Prize Papers are documents that were confiscated by the British Navy and privateers from enemy ships in the period between 1652 and 1815. In total 35,000 ships were captured, from which a large number of documents were retrieved as they were required as evidence to prove the legality of the capture. The Dutch collection contains various types of documents: ships logs, cargo manifests, bills, plantation lists, letters of recommendation, interrogations of crew members but also letters from and to sailors, merchants and their families. The letters come from all sections of

society; most are written by women and most never reached their destination. The database (see link in section 2.4) can be searched on ship's name, captain's name, date of capture and language. For each document scans of the original pages are available, and also the automatically generated transcription.

Other Genre

Business letters

Other Genre

Ship's journals

Other Genre

Lists of cargo

Other Genre

Accounts

Other Genre

Plantation lists

Other Genre

Interrogations

Other Genre

Private letters

Topic Classification

[Databases for humanities](#)

Languages

[Dutch](#)

Languages

[Danish](#)

Languages

French

Languages

English

Languages

German

languageOther

other languages

Geographical Coverage

Europe, Africa, America, Asia

TemporalCoverage

Temporal Coverage Start Date

1652

Temporal Coverage End Date

1815

2.2 Dates

dateFrom

2016-01-01

dateTo

2019-07-01

2.3 Creators and Contributors

Publishing Organisation

Name

Huygens Institute for History and Culture of the Netherlands

ROR ID

<https://ror.org/04x6kq749>
 Type
 Academic/Research Institution
 Creators
 Name
 Marijcke Schillings
 ORCID ID
<https://orcid.org/0000-0001-7534-2652>
 Organisation
 Huygens Institute for History and Culture of the Netherlands
 ROR ID
<https://ror.org/04x6kq749>
 Role
 Project Administration
 Creators
 Name
 Jelle van Lottum
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<https://orcid.org/0000-0003-0534-4745>
 Organisation
 Huygens Institute for History and Culture of the Netherlands
 ROR ID
<https://ror.org/04x6kq749>
 Role
 Supervision
 contributors
 organisation
 The National Archives, Kew, London, UK
 descriptionContribution
 Made original archive documents available for scanning
 contributors
 organisation
 National Archives, The Hague, The Netherlands
 descriptionContribution
 Stored the original scanned images
 contributors
 organisation
 National Library of the Netherlands
 descriptionContribution
 Members of the project team/Metamorfoze
 contributors
 organisation
 MicroFormat Systems B.V.
 descriptionContribution
 Supplied the scanner and did the scanning at The National Archives, Kew, London
 Funding Source
 Name
 Metamorfoze (National Library of the Netherlands)

ROR ID

<https://ror.org/02w4jbg70>

Funding or Grant Summary

Metamorfoze is the national programme of the National Library of the Netherlands for preserving and providing access to paper heritage. Project code MMHING01

link

<https://www.metamorfoze.nl/front>

Funding Source

Name

Samenwerkende Maritieme Fondsen

link

<https://www.samenwerkendemaritiemefondsen.nl>

2.4 Distribution

Repository

<https://prizepapers.huygens.knaw.nl/>

2.5 Licenses and Accesses

Access

Access Level

Open Access

2.6 Dataset Version and Maintenance

Version

Current Version

1

Maintenance

Maintenance Status

Deprecated

Maintenance Plan

Updates

This dataset will not be further enlarged. Possibly the transcriptions will be updated with improved versions.

2.7 Feedback and Elaboration

Feedback and Elaboration

Various employees of the contributing institutions worked together to create this dataset.

Level 3: Data

3.1 Data Resource Description

Name of Resource

Dutch Prize Papers - Scans

Description

The Prize Papers are kept in the Archive of the High Court of Admiralty (HCA) in The National Archives in Kew, London. Approximately a quarter of these come from Dutch ships. Two series have been selected: HCA 30 series consists of miscellaneous Admiralty papers. HCA 32 series consists of papers relating to cases concerning ships captured. The Prize Papers were examined at the National Archives in Kew, London. Collection experts made a selection of boxes of papers that contained large amounts of Dutch papers. These

represented a spread both in time and in geographical location. As the boxes contained mixes of documents, some papers not pertaining to Dutch ships (and also in other languages) were also included. The papers from the selected boxes were preserved and then scanned on location in London, and the scans were checked. Due to the need for preservation prior to scanning, some selected papers were not scanned when preservation could not be completed on time. Also, some large documents could not be scanned. Approximately 60m of the estimated 750m of Dutch documents in the Prize Papers collection were scanned. The scans are stored by the National Archives of the Netherlands. The scans contained in this dataset are copies of the original scans, and are stored at the Huygens Institute. The scans can be searched, viewed and individually downloaded via the Dutch Prize Papers website, see the link in Section 2.4 Images have been reproduced by permission of The National Archives, London, England. The National Archives give no warranty as to the accuracy, completeness or fitness for the purpose of the information provided. Images may be used only for purposes of research, private study or education. Applications for any other use should be made to The National Archives Image Library, Kew, Richmond, Surrey TW9 4DU, see: www.nationalarchives.gov.uk/imagelibrary/.

Language(s)

Dutch, English, French, German, Danish and other languages

Data Subject(s)

Subject(s)

Non-sensitive data about people

Data Modality

Modality

Image Data

descriptiveStatistics

statistics

72000 scans, 101 inventory numbers, 297 shipmaster names, 275 ship names, 6 different languages (uncertain)

3.2 Data Fields

dataField

Data Field Name

Scan name

Data Field Type

[string](#)

Description of the Data Field

The name of the scan contains an identifier which contains a reference to the National Archives of the Netherlands, where the original scans are stored.

3.3 Data Point Examples

Typical Example

Description

Example of a letter ((1803) HCA32-996-0136),
example of a ship's journal ((1804)
HCA32-1172.5268-0055b)

Link

<https://prizepapers.huygens.knaw.nl/framed3.html?imagesetuuid=ff440cad-655d-4a5d-a08d-fae8f916fea5&uri=https://images.diginfra.net/api/pim/iiif/ff440cad-655d-4a5d-a08d-fae8f916fea5/canvas/5d0f149e-5a93-4fea-b898-14aa9a9acbd2,https://prizepapers.huygens.knaw.nl/framed3.html?imagesetuuid=2442867a-38f3-45c3-a681-b80dcaa8ae24&uri=https://images.diginfra.net/api/pim/iiif/2442867a-38f3-45c3-a681-b80dcaa8ae24/canvas/7ae08cc2-d650-427e-805e-cadd7ff24435>

Atypical Example

Description

Scans of documents in other languages than Dutch

3.4 Errors, Noise, and Redundancies

Description

The readability of documents varies depending on their condition and on the handwriting of the writer. Some documents have suffered damage from damp, binding or ink corrosion.

3.5 External Resources

Resources

Yes

3.7 Social Impact, Sensitivity, and Biases

Safety Consideration

Does the resource contain data that, if viewed directly, might be offensive, insulting, threatening, or might otherwise cause anxiety?

Yes

If yes or you are not sure, please specify:

There are documents from plantations (West Indies)

Confidentiality

confidentialityBin

No

biases

Known Biases in the Resource

This is a historical dataset and as such the content of the scans reflects the social and economic structures of the time. Only documents from ships that were taken over by British ships, and for which this takeover was judged to be justified by the High Court of Admiralty (HCA), came into this collection. Documents may have been lost over time. Being a selection, this dataset may not contain all relevant papers to Dutch ships that are present in the original Prize Papers collection. Also, some selected papers could not be preserved in time to be

scanned, and some large documents could not be scanned.

Sensitive Attributes

Sensitive Human Attributes

Others (please specify)

Specify

The resource contains scans of personal letters, from the 17th to 19th centuries

Ethical Review

Review

No

3.8 Data Provenance

Name

Prize Papers scans at the National Archives of the Netherlands

URL

<https://www.nationaalarchief.nl/onderzoeken/archief/2.22.24/invnr/%40HCA30?query=2.22.24&search-type=inventory&start=0&searchAfter=1%2C%40HCA30>

Description

These are the original scans produced onsite in The National Archives, Kew, London, UK of the selected Prize Papers.

Creator Name(s)

Huygens Institute Dutch Prize Papers Project Team

Creator Organisation(s)

Huygens Institute for History and Culture of the Netherlands

Creator Organisation(s)

Metamorfoze (National Library of the Netherlands)

Creator Organisation(s)

MicroFormat

Creator Organisation(s)

National Archive of the Netherlands

Language(s)

Dutch, French, English, German, Danish and other languages

Temporal Scope

1652-1815

Geographical Scope

Europe, Africa, America, Asia

Notable Features

This is a historical dataset and as such the content of the scans reflects the social and economic structures of the time. Only documents from ships that were taken over by British ships, and for which this takeover was judged to be justified by the High Court of Admiralty (HCA), came into this collection. Documents may have been lost over time. Being a selection, this dataset may not contain all relevant papers to Dutch ships that are present in the original Prize Papers collection. Also, some selected

papers could not be preserved in time to be scanned, and some large documents could not be scanned.

3.8 Data Provenance

Name

High Court of Admiralty: Prize Court: Prize Papers

Description

The Prize Papers are kept in the Archive of the High Court of Admiralty (HCA) in The National Archives in Kew, London.

3.9 Digitisation

Digitalisation Pipeline

Not all papers were scanned due to selection of Dutch papers and due to time pressures meaning that some selected papers could not be preserved in time to be digitised

Level 3: Data

3.1 Data Resource Description

Name of Resource

Dutch Prize Papers - metadata and transcriptions

Description

This is the metadata that pertains to the papers that were scanned, and the automatic transcription of each scan. The metadata for each scan was retrieved from The National Archives (UK) website and translated to Dutch or, where the metadata for the scan was absent, the relevant details were obtained by reading the scan. The metadata includes the ship's name, ship's master, capture date and language of the document. Scans are grouped into inventories. The 72000 scans are distributed over 87 inventory numbers. To aid search, the scans were processed by the Loghi Handwritten Text Recognition tool to produce automatic transcriptions. <https://github.com/knaw-huc/loghi>. 100 scans were manually annotated with the ground truth of the text they contained, using the Transkribus platform (<https://www.transkribus.org/>). These scans and their ground truth were used to train the Loghi model before it was applied to produce automatic transcriptions for all scans. The metadata and the automatic transcriptions can be searched and viewed via the Dutch Prize Papers website, see the link in Section 2.4.

Language(s)

Dutch

Data Subject(s)

Subject(s)

Synthetically generated data

Data Modality

Modality

Text Data

descriptiveStatistics

statistics

72000 scans, 101 inventory numbers, 297
shipmaster names, 275 ship names, 6 different
languages (uncertain)

3.2 Data Fields

dataField

Data Field Name

Series

Data Field Type

string

Description of the Data Field

This field contains the inventory number of a given
scan

dataField

Data Field Name

Ship name

Data Field Type

string

Description of the Data Field

Name of the ship. If a place of origin is known it is
mentioned behind the ship name in brackets; ship
names in more than one language are listed next to
each other

dataField

Data Field Name

Ship master

Data Field Type

string

Description of the Data Field

The name of the master of a ship. If known, his
place of origin is mentioned behind the captain's
name (between brackets).

dataField

Data Field Name

Capture date

Data Field Type

string

Description of the Data Field

The year in which the ship was captured. Where
this is not known, an estimate of the period was
derived from the dates of the documents.

dataField

Data Field Name

Language

Data Field Type

string

Description of the Data Field

The detected language of the text of the scan. The
language detection is mostly based on printed texts
such as newspapers, so does not yield good results
for handwritten texts.

3.3 Data Point Examples

Typical Example

Description

SHIP Zwarte Paard SHIP MASTER Willem Bleij
CAPTURE DATE 1666 LANGUAGE (DETECTED) nl
AUTOMATIC TRANSCRIPTION Franscois de
Vandosme hartogh van Beaufort, Prins van
Martigues groot Meester ende super intendent
generael vande Navigatie ende Franse Commersie,
ende aen allen den gene die desen jegenwoordige
letteren sullen sien sal uijt, teweten dat het
Nootsaekelijckenis ten dienste vanden koninck ende
Vrijheijt der Commersije Soowel voorde
onderdaenen als voor die geallieerde, in faveur
vande welcke sijn Majesteijt heeft verobligeert
geweest om een open verclaringe te doen tegens
d'engelsen tot dien eijnde omme voor te Comen
sijnede exerceren dagelijks si de roverije die op
Zee op de Custen van dit Coninckrijck wij hebben
gegeven vollemacht ende permissie Aen S:r Willem
Bleij om het schip genaamt tswartepaert tot ten
oorloogh uijt terusten groot ontrent 12 vadt
wesende tegenwoordigh tot Duijnckercken omdien
te Equiperen met een getalen manner Cruijt ende
andere Canons, Cogels, loot uy6 gereetschappen tot
ten oorloogh ende vivers noodigh om in zee
tebrengen, omtebaren de Custen ende reeden van
Vanckrijck engelant, sponien barbarije ende
opsoodon nige andere ploets, die hij goet duncken
sal geduyrende den tijt van een jaer om te loopen
Engelsen ende andere 8 opde voors vijanden
vanden staet rovers ende ende onchristen Rourlijk
den oorvangs aen te dee Translaet pril: Basteels

Link

<https://prizepapers.huygens.knaw.nl/framed3.html?imagesetuuid=51322c1e-d670-40ca-acd0-2271ffa14090&uri=https://images.diginfra.net/api/pim/iiif/51322c1e-d670-40ca-acd0-2271ffa14090/canvas/ee98e6fd-e261-474e-8844-d1adaf096a77>

3.4 Errors, Noise, and Redundancies

Description

The automatic transcripts contain errors from the
handwritten text recognition

3.5 External Resources

Resources

Yes

3.7 Social Impact, Sensitivity, and Biases

Safety Consideration

Does the resource contain data that, if viewed directly,
might be offensive, insulting, threatening, or might
otherwise cause anxiety?

Yes

If yes or you are not sure, please specify:

There are documents from plantations (West Indies)

Confidentiality

confidentialityBin

No

biases

Sensitive Attributes

Sensitive Human Attributes

None

Ethical Review

Review

No

3.8 Data Provenance

Name

High Court of Admiralty: Prize Court: Prize Papers

URL

<https://www.nationaalarchief.nl/onderzoeken/archief/2.22.24/invnr/%40HCA30?query=2.22.24&search-type=inventory&start=0&searchAfter=1%2C%40HCA30>

Description

The National Archives (UK) possesses the metadata of the original Prize Papers collection. This was used in the creation of the selected metadata for the Dutch Prize Papers

Creator Organisation(s)

The National Archives, Kew, London, UK

Level 4: Uses

purposes

Research

Motivating Factor(s) and Problem Space(s)

To make the Dutch portion of the Prize Papers digitally available online for researchers. Limited time and budget combined with the specific interests of the project led to the selection of boxes of papers containing large numbers of Dutch papers with a spread both in time and in geographical location. Time limitations also meant that not all papers could be preserved and digitised on time.

4.1. Uses

datasetUse

Safe for research use

LinksToRelatedItems

Publications

<https://maritiemportal.nl/blog-dutch-prize-papers-huygens-ing-knaw/#more-19325>

Publications

<https://www.huygens.knaw.nl/wp-content/uploads/2021/07/Literatuur-datasets-PP-juli-2019-update-2.pdf>

Publications

<https://maritiemportal.nl/blog-dutch-prize-papers-huygens-instituut-knaw-deel-2/#more-26572>

Publications

<https://maritiemportal.nl/blog-duiken-in-dutch-prize-papers/#more-29514>

Suitable Use Case(s)

Suitable Use Case

Searching the documents based on the metadata, research based on close reading of the scans, statistics of the metadata (except for language)

Additional Notes

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Unsuitable Use Case(s)

unsuitableUseCase

Analysis of language, as this metadata facet is of poor quality. Use of the images for purposes other than research, private study or education (unless a special application has been made to The National Archives Image Library).

4.2. Use with Other Data

Safety Level

Unknown - then skip the rest of this subsection

4.3 Use in ML or AI Systems

Dataset Uses

Development or Production Use

Other dataset use

100 scans were manually annotated with the ground truth of the text they contained. These scans and their ground truth were used to train the Loghi Handwritten Text Recognition Toolkit <https://github.com/knaw-huc/loghi>

4.4. Sampling

safetyLevel

Unknown - then skip the rest of this section

Level 5: Human Perspective

5.2. Creators and Contributors

Description of potential positionality impact factors

The selection of papers for scanning was made by historical experts from the Huygens Institute and the National Library of the Netherlands, respecting a balance of time and place.